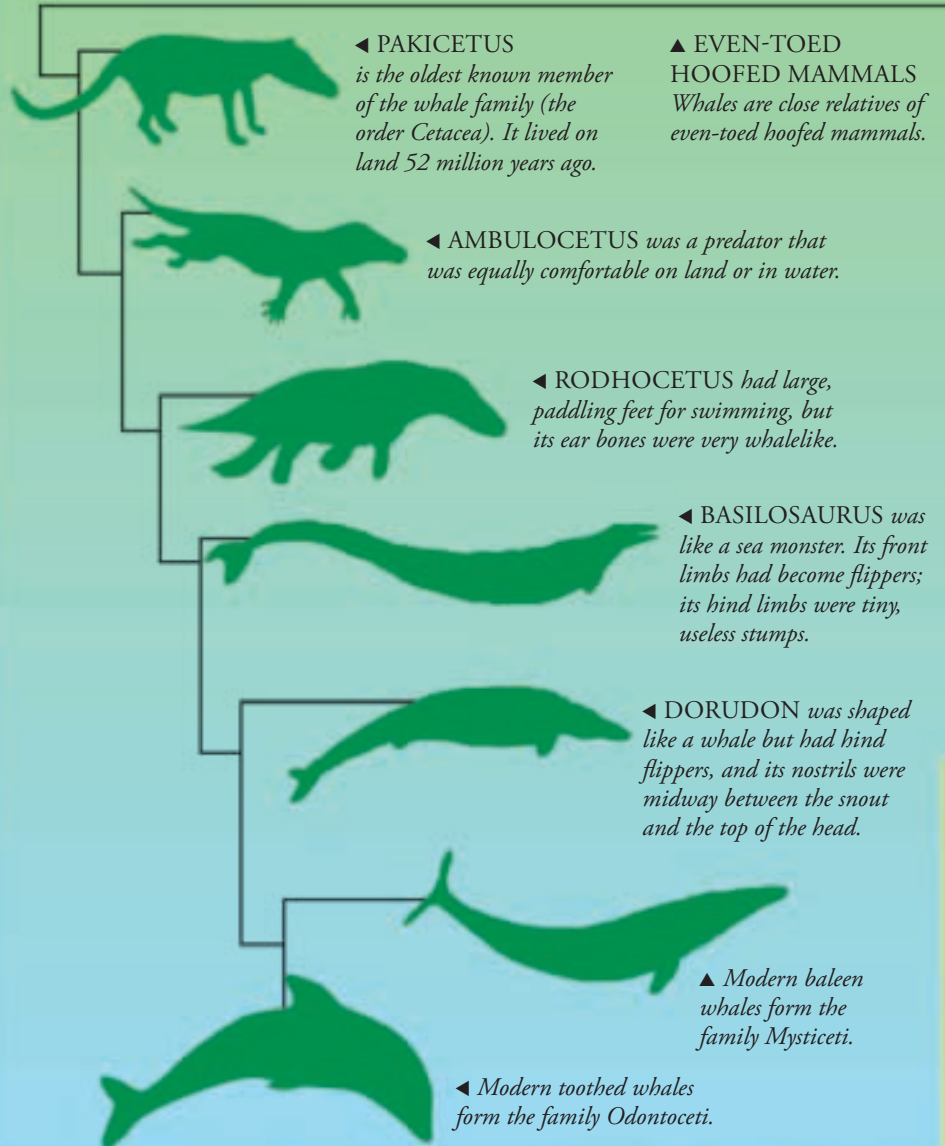


THE FAMILY TREE

Scientists haven't found enough fossils to trace the evolution of whales in full. However, a handful of fascinating discoveries from different parts of the whale family tree give us snapshots of evolution in action, with later species ever-better adapted to life in water as their limbs evolved into flippers and their nostrils moved backward to become blowholes.



MAMMALS



WHALES TODAY

There are now more than 100 species of whale and dolphin. They are divided into two main types: toothed whales, which hunt fish, and baleen whales, which use plates of bristles in the mouth to sift small animals from the water. The humpback whale (right) is a type of baleen whale.

